

Hard disk woes

Q. I recently partitioned my 40 GB HDD using fdisk from DOS. The partition structure of my hard disk is as follows C: (Fat32), D: (Ext2), E: (Linux Swap), F: (NTFS), G: (FAT32), H: (FAT32). I had installed Windows Me on the C drive, Windows XP on the F drive, and Linux on the D drive. After repeated attempts I was unable to install X-Windows in Linux, so I removed Linux and re-installed Windows Me. Now my boot loader shows Windows XP and Windows Me, but boots only to WinME. 'fdisk' does not run and hangs the machine. I tried loading Partition Magic 6.0 but this shows an error 'Disk Geometry error. Partition's drive letter cannot be identified'. Please help me solve this problem.

Amit Paul

A Nothing to worry about Amit, just use a Windows XP bootable CD to repair the Windows installation. If that doesn't solve it, run the XP setup and delete the Linux partition when you are prompted to partition your hard disk. XP will automatically detect previous versions and configure the boot loader accordingly.

Speed Boosters

Q. I have a Pentium III 933 MHz PC with 128 MB SD RAM. My computer takes a long time to start. Secondly, the CD-ROM drive takes a long time to access when I click on My Computer. I want to make my PC faster, is there any software available that will do this?

Nitish Trikannad

A Tsk, Tsk! Always remember to mention the operating system you use. In general, uninstalling all unnecessary applications, closing all background programs, and deleting unused fonts from the 'Windows\Fonts' directory will speed up your computer. You can use 'msconfig', an inbuilt utility to do most of this (go to Start > Run and type 'msconfig', and press [Enter]). As for your CD-ROM, it probably has a faulty lens and therefore takes time to identify CDs. Replace the drive if it's within the warranty period.

Graphic Card for Game

Q. I have bought an old Hercules stingray PCI 128/3D model S3318 card. Can you please tell

me the site from where I can download the drivers of the card? Also tell me if I can play Grand Theft Auto 3 using this card.

Sanjana sinha

A The drivers for this card can be found at http://us.hercules.com/support/old_driver.php3. Click on the appropriate operating system to get the drivers. Unfortunately, you will not be able to play GTA 3 as the card does not meet the minimum requirements for the game (16 MB 3D video card).

Ring tone on Infrared

Q. I have a Nokia 8250. It has an infrared communication system. I would like to send Ring tone from PC to my mobile. What are the things I will require.

A In order to send a ring tone from your PC, you must first connect your phone to it. This can be done either via a data cable or using an infrared port. So you need to purchase a compatible data cable or get an external infrared port if your PC does not have one. You will also need connectivity software such as Nokia PC suite. Once connected, depending on the software you use, you will be able to send a ring tone across. If you use a Nokia PC suite, you can compose your ring tone and click on the 'Send to phone' button

www.Blank.page

Q. Whenever I try to open Web pages (both offline or online), the Internet Explorer 6 window appears blank, but I can see the title and icons. I have a Pentium III, SM56 Motorola Internal modem, and runs Windows XP Professional.

Sudeep

A This problem occurs due to a rendering fault with IE. Try installing an alternate browser, such as Opera, to see if it persists. If Opera works well, then you need to re-install Internet Explorer.